V.O.L.T.

2026

VALUING ONTARIO LIBRARIES TOOLKIT

Capturing the Value of Public Libraries Across Ontario

ABOUT THE TOOLKIT

NORDIK Institute and Ontario Library Service (OLS) developed a common Social Return on Investment (SROI) framework to help Ontario public libraries measure and demonstrate their value.



Informed by community engagement across Ontario, VOLT builds on the Valuing Northern Libraries Toolkit developed in 2016. The province-wide toolkit launched in December 2023.

SEVEN DOMAINS OF IMPACT

A shared framework for calculating the social return on library investment.

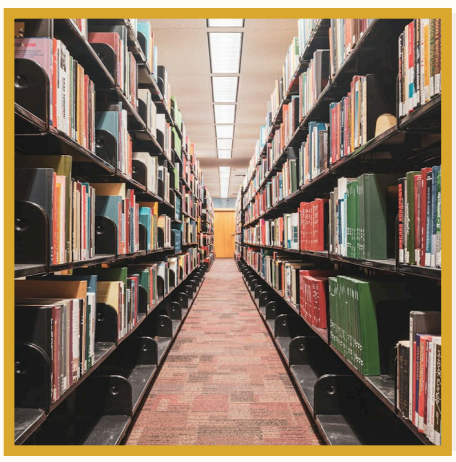
01 Education
02 Culture
03 Inclusion and Wellbeing
04 Entertainment and Leisure
05 Economic Development
06 Civic Engagement
07 Space

CURRENT PHASE

Under this framework, the Valuing Ontario Libraries Toolkit was launched in December 2023. The project is now in the phase of revising the Valuing Ontario Libraries Toolkit based on the feedback provided by the users.

OUTPUT

Many public libraries in Ontario are now using this toolkit to generate their Library Value Reports and share them with stakeholders.



EXPLORE THE TOOLKIT

Guidance and resources for demonstrating the value of your public library.

resources.olservice.ca/volt

Scan to explore

Research team
Dr. Tamanna Rimi · Dr. Sean Meades · Dr. Jude Ortiz
Harsh Morye · Mayesha Verma

With support from Ontario Library Service

Northern Ontario Research, Development, Ideas and Knowledge
NORDIK INSTITUTE
ONTARIO LIBRARY SERVICE
Stronger libraries. Stronger communities.